I READ 8,473 JOB POSTINGS

What do employers REALLY ask for?

Product Manager vs Project Manager vs Data Analyst.
The #1 skill for each might surprise you.

Based on 8,473 real job postings

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THE #1 SKILL PER ROLE

PRODUCT MANAGER

Product Roadmap

70%
of postings

PROJECT MANAGER

Budget Management

56%
of postings

DATA ANALYST

SQL

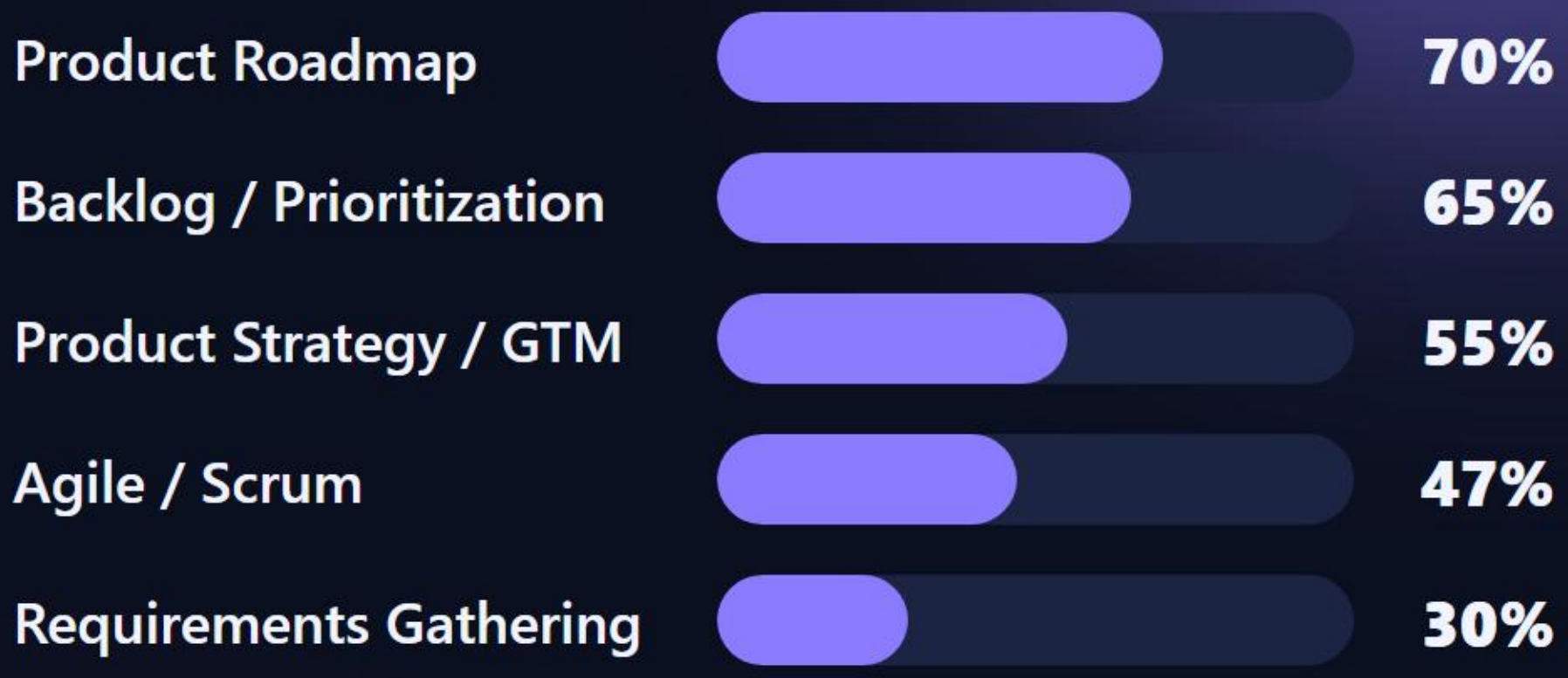
67%
of postings

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PRODUCT MANAGER

Top 5 hard skills



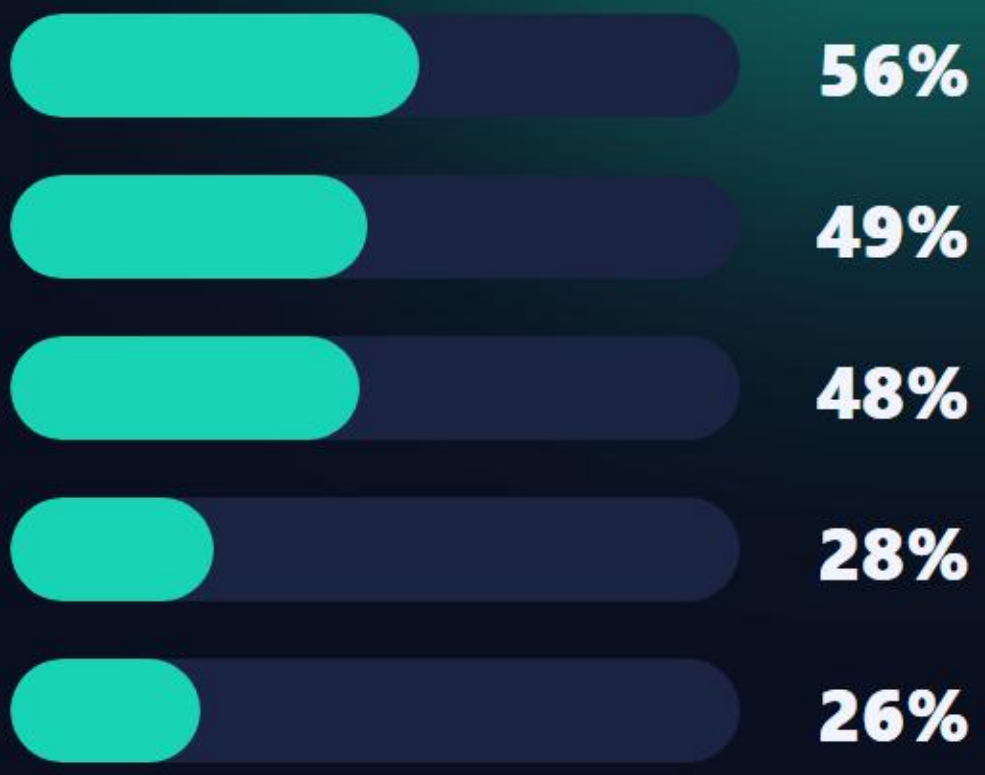
Product Roadmap is asked in 70% of Product Manager postings, and 16x more often than in the other two roles.

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PROJECT MANAGER

Top 5 hard skills



Budget Management is asked in 56% of Project Manager postings, and 5x more often than in the other two roles.

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DATA ANALYST

Top 5 hard skills



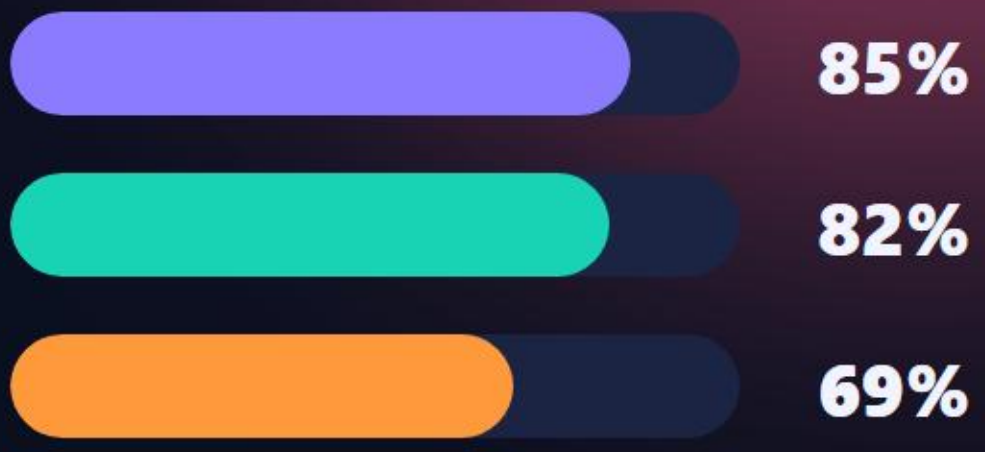
SQL is asked in 67% of Data Analyst postings, and 11x more often than in the other two roles.

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THE ONE SKILL EVERYONE WANTS

Communication



It is in **69%-85%** of postings in every role. Expected everywhere, so it will not set you apart. Hard skills do.

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WHO NEEDS WHAT

Same market, different skill sets

	Product Manager	Project Manager	Data Analyst
SQL	8%	2%	67%
Python	3%	0%	43%
Product Roadmap	70%	4%	5%
Product Strategy / GTM	55%	0%	2%
Budget Management	11%	56%	7%
PM Certification	4%	28%	2%
Reporting	27%	49%	67%
Communication	85%	82%	69%

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HOW I BUILT IT

SQL does the counting

```
WITH with_skill AS (
  SELECT p.role, m.skill, COUNT(*) AS n_with
  FROM postings p
  JOIN job_skill_mined m ON m.job_id = p.job_id
  GROUP BY p.role, m.skill)
SELECT role, skill,
  1.0 * n_with / n_postings AS demand_pct,
  ROW_NUMBER() OVER (PARTITION BY role
    ORDER BY demand_pct DESC) AS skill_rank
FROM with_skill ...
```

CTEs and window functions turn **8,473** postings and **78,850** skill mentions into one ranked table per role.

EXPLORE IT YOURSELF

Pick a role, see your top 3

Interactive dashboard
oriyakli1-ui.github.io/linkedin-skills-analysis

Code, SQL, Power BI project
github.com/oriyakli1-ui/linkedin-skills-analysis

Python + SQL + Power BI. Open source, no personal data.

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THE TAKEAWAY

Learn what is role-defining, not just popular

Product Manager: Product Roadmap, Backlog, Product Strategy

Project Manager: Budget Management, Reporting, Risk, PM Certification

Data Analyst: SQL, Data Visualization, Statistics, Python

Follow for more data-backed career advice.

Sources: LinkedIn 2022-25, Indeed/ZipRecruiter 2024. Aggregated, no personal data.